01 | CCEs | DESK REFERENCE

# CCEs: Quick Message Check

Run through this before you send, forward, or act on work direction.

> **Required for leadership messages**
> Written expectations, changes, decisions, and reminders from leadership need CCEs 1–5. Add CCE 6 when a source document applies. Greetings and "got it" replies are exempt.

| Element | Check |
|---|---|
| **1. What is changing or being asked** | Who, what, and by when are all stated. |
| **2. Why / Why it is changing** | The reason is given. |
| **3. Who owns it and who decides** | The worker and the decision-maker are both named. |
| **4. What is not changing** | What stays the same is stated. |
| **5. What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** | A contact and a reply time are given. |
| **6. Where this lives (whenever applicable)** | The form, policy, or guide is linked or named. |

## Passing a message along?

Keep the action, reason, deadline, audience, and decision-maker the same. Simpler words are fine. New meaning is not. If something is missing, ask. Don't fill the gap yourself.

## Receiving direction?

Say it back in your own words:

> *"So I need to _____ by _____. I'm responsible for _____. I still need to check _____ with _____."*

> **Before you hit send**
> Could someone read this and know the next step, the deadline, and who to ask? If they would have to open a link to find out, add it to the message.

*Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.*